

RETURN TO THE ORIGINAL LEVEL OF PERFECTION

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. May this evening prove a blessing for every one of you. May it give you the necessary inspiration and help to proceed a step further in your search, in your endeavor towards finding yourself.

Every once in a while, it is important to restate what this pathwork is and what it is supposed to accomplish. And it is important to see this ever in a new light, from a different angle. A path such as this should not be considered as anything but a help to fulfill one's life as completely as possible, to fulfill oneself in this life. It is not supposed to be taken as a cure, nor is it to be taken as a luxury indulged in merely because it is "interesting," because it certainly cannot "harm," and because one's life leaves room for such an interesting pursuit. In reality, it is much more important, much more basic. And if it be a cure or a healing, it is that only as a secondary consideration. The true meaning of such pathwork is finding in the self that which leads to the personal fulfillment of one's personal destiny. If this pathwork is taken from such point of view, much misunderstanding will be eliminated.

Even my friends who are very diligent and full of good will in this work often overlook or forget or still do not sufficiently comprehend that everything that one can possibly need exists in man in complete and total perfection. This potential is a reality. And it is the finding of this level, where these possibilities become a reality, that this pathwork is all about.

On the physical level of man's system, this is obvious. The physical system works in absolute perfection when the physical laws are adhered to. The less they are adhered to, due to ignorance or deliberate self-destructiveness, the more man moves away from that physical level on which perfection is a reality. I advisedly formulate it in this way, for there is a difference between the perfect functioning of one's physical faculties being absent and conceiving of physical health, and the concept I present you herewith, in which I say that the level on which perfect functioning exists is right here and right there, only you have moved away from it. Gradually, by understanding the laws and how you have violated them, health can be reestablished and returned, step by step, to the original level where the perfect functioning exists. If the usually held concept were correct, that perfect functioning "goes away," as it were, you could not possibly regain it. You can regain perfect functioning only because you have been away from it and have come back to it. The more you have moved away from this perfect functioning, the more difficult is it to retrace the way back through the various causes and effects, through all the points in the chain reaction. It is easy for anyone to see that, originally, as long as the laws of physical functioning were not tampered with, the physical system is arranged by nature in such a way that it works in absolute perfection, giving man strength and well-being.

Strangely enough, this is less obvious to man when it comes to the mental and psychic levels. There, the identical laws operate, and it is exactly the same thing. By nature, man is meant, just as his body is meant, to function in perfection, and so his mental and emotional life is meant to function in perfection. When he realizes this original level, he is "home." He has reached that within him which can procure him that which life is meant to fulfill for him, that which he is meant to fulfill for life -- for the two are one.

This fulfillment, in its variety and its limitless possibility for fruitful experience and expansion, is a reality that exists permanently inside. When man is unfulfilled and unhappy, he has moved away with his consciousness from this possibility, from this potential. It is exceedingly important, my friends, to conceive of it this way. For then you will shorten the peregrinations that alienate you from this center of your being in which a strength and a possibility and a wisdom and a power lie, which none of you can as yet completely comprehend.

Before I come back to this point, as to why it is so difficult for you to comprehend, I should like to discuss the following. Let us again, from a different angle, recapitulate what happens when you are away from this possibility. Each concept, each idea, each thought, and each action are both cause and energy. It sets an energy in motion which creates a series for chain reactions. In the nature of being cause, it also creates effects. The energy which creates the ensuing chain reactions produces the effects of the original cause, the original nucleus of energy. In the last lecture, I discussed the self-perpetuating principle. The sequence of chain reactions caused by any thought, idea, or action is exactly what I meant -- it is self-perpetuating once the original thought is issued forth.

If this original thought or concept is in accord with truth, the ensuing chain reactions are bound to be constructive, positive, conflictless, agreeable, and lead to further expansion, further constructiveness, further agreeableness, and so on, since the self-perpetuating principle is at work. When the original concept is in error, (I mean at any given instant, in any situation, a human being formulates a concept or thought or intent that is conceived in error) the ensuing chain reactions must be negative, confining, destructive, and disagreeable.

Let us take any idea that you formulate. Such an idea, whether truthful or untruthful, will lead you to certain assumptions. These assumptions will lead you to certain actions (or to the lack of them). They, in turn, will lead to responses and reactions by others, by the world around you. Their responses will again cause further reactions within you so that you formulate further concepts which are gathered by all these ensuing interactions. And so it goes on and on and on. The original misconception leads to graver error, to compounded misunderstanding, to further alienation from the truth in that respect. Each cause produces an effect. This effect becomes simultaneously a new cause, producing a new effect, which in turn must become the cause for the next effect. This is the nature of the self-perpetuating chain reaction.

When such a negative chain reaction is activated, each link, which is simultaneously cause and effect, must be retraced; and it must be understood and subsequently abandoned so that the personality finds the way back to the original level where no conflict exists and where fruitful expansion is a reality. On this level, fearlessness, peace, unlimited unfoldment, stimulation -- all that man could possibly desire -- exist. The further removed you are, the more difficult it becomes to find the way back. As with impaired physical health, so it is on the mental and psychic levels. The

more the laws are violated, the more negative chain reactions come into being. The mental and psychic laws are as exact and definite as the laws of the physical body. They can be understood in a similar fashion and are not more difficult to comprehend or to ascertain. The physical system contains an inherent healing force which is always ready to cooperate with man if but given a chance. That is, when man makes an effort to comprehend the laws, to correct the impairment, when he trusts this healing natural force while he does his best, this live power begins to operate. It is exactly the same on the mental and psychic levels. There, too, healing powers exist. These powers strive toward wholeness, constructiveness, productiveness, expansion, fulfillment. If man allows them to operate by sensing their direction and by removing the obstacles which have broken the laws that pertain, these psychic healing forces will become an ever increasing power which will sweep man forward.

The further removed you are in your mental confusions and destructive emotions, the more difficult it becomes to return to that original level. Correcting each link in the chain reaction fills man with dread. Unreasonably, he fears this because it seems to exact from him something which he is unwilling to give.

Now, my friends, this is briefly the work of this path, reformulated. I think if you can conceive of it in this slightly different way, it will activate in you a new energy, a new incentive, a new insight. And it is also important for you to understand that life, for anyone who wants to live it successfully, must be led according to these premises, namely, to find the way back to this original potential; to understand the laws governing the physical, the mental, the emotional system; to comprehend the perfection of these laws and to adhere to them.

Now, what is fundamentally the greatest violation that leads to further chain reactions of violation, error, confusion, destructiveness? I would say the most important is ignorance of this process. When man ignores the inherent potential he has, the limitless powers he possesses (literally, my friends!) for exactly what he needs, for every contingency, this is a fundamental violation which inevitably leads to further alienation and destruction. When man realizes that there is no situation in his life that needs to remain unresolved, unhappy, frightening, that he has all possibilities within him to solve any problem he has gotten himself into, regardless of what it is, once he realizes this, he has fulfilled the main premise, which affords him the possibility to return to this level of fulfillment he has gotten away from in the course of many, many, many centuries. This removal may exist in certain areas only, while in other areas of his personality he may be very closely in touch with this original level of perfection, of dynamic life and unfoldment. But there are those impaired areas man has brought with him into this life. Not knowing that he has the possibility of dissolving them -- that is the greatest hindrance. For, strange as it may seem, my friends, even though people in principle may be perfectly aware of these facts just discussed here as a theory and as a philosophy, many, many times the very same people ignore and cannot apply this to their own impaired areas, and they are perplexed and hopeless and paralyzed because it simply does not occur to them that they have within themselves the possibility of correcting any situation they are in which is not to their satisfaction.

Man cannot use or activate this limitless power for purposes outside of himself if he has not mastered himself first. This means that he has to correct the impaired areas of his being. He must use the power to return to the point of departure from the original level of perfection. He must use the power to switch from destructiveness to constructiveness, from separateness to inclusion. He

must use the power to become aware of where he impairs his integrity and therefore violates the psychic laws. He must use the power to let go of the pseudosafety of hate and cruelty and change his personality into that of love for others. When he uses the power to first determine where he finds himself in an illusion about himself, and uncovers where he is not as decent and as loving as he thought, and then further uses it to change this condition, he appropriately makes use of the powers at his disposal. Once man has mastered himself in such a way, the power will automatically expand and extend. Through such mastery, the realization that he and everyone else are one will not be merely words, but will have become a living reality within himself. But as long as man has not mastered himself, these will, at best, be words, and at worst, it will mean nothing. As long as the self and others seem separated, there must appear a conflict of interest between the self and others, which forces man to be destructive -- either of the self or of the other. And since they are one, either way must ultimately also effect the other person and respectively the self. Hence the power cannot be used, for in order to do so, there must exist a free, happy, uninhibited feeling which cannot arise out of conflict.

The first prerequisite to return to this original level of perfection, of limitless possibilities, of meaningful expansion and experience, of pleasure supreme, is knowing that this level is intact inside and merely has to be activated by consciousness. But hearing it, my friends, and even vaguely thinking it, and knowing it are not the same. And this knowledge must be cultivated. The awareness that your immediate problem can be solved and that you have within you everything you need in order to do this, that must be the first step in any given phase.

Often man does not want to even acknowledge this possibility. For this possibility, once it is truly met, must reveal where and how man himself has violated the pertaining laws and where and how he must correct the situation. In reality, this is never undesirable. In reality, it always proves to be eminently good, from every conceivable point of view. It never deprives, but it requires courage and integrity. It appears as though this correcting process imposes a heavy toll. But in reality, the heavy toll is exacted by shying away from meeting the total situation in total integrity. In fact, as mentioned before, the longer this is done, the further man removes himself from all that is good and peaceful, hence the heavier becomes the price he inevitably pays. Man foolishly talks himself into a hopeless situation because he thus hopes to avoid the correction which only seems a sacrifice.

Now, my friends, when you look at your lives and question yourselves, where could you expand more? Where could you experience life more deeply and fully? Where could you be freer from any sort of disharmony within or around you? Where could you give and receive more? And when you then precisely acknowledge these empty areas or destructive areas and when you then acknowledge the possibility that within you lie the tools with which to correct the situation, then will you do what is purposeful and constructive, what is indeed necessary. Everything else will follow suit. Then it will become possible for you to retrace the various negative chain reactions, find the laws in question, and change your attitude and behavior regarding these laws. You will work with, instead of against, them. But as long as you gloss over either your difficulties, your emptiness, or you gloss over their cause and pretend that the cause has nothing or little to do with you -- at least with you now -- you cannot go back to where you have to be within yourself.

The next violation of the mental law is that of false ideas. We have often talked about this in many different forms. Any false concept man has is always directly related somehow to not wanting to accept a truth about himself. We must distinguish here between general areas of life, of science,

of philosophy, which either have no direct bearing on an individual's personal life or which are still way beyond his present possibility of comprehension. It goes without saying that man in his general, overall present state of development cannot possibly know everything. But when it applies to areas man is essentially capable of understanding, provided he is unblocked and honest with himself, any untruth he abides by in his beliefs must affect his inner and outer life since this false belief is a product of his inner attitude. Therefore we cannot say that a person's spiritual beliefs are unrelated to his emotional attitudes. Whether or not man believes, what and how he believes, the attitude in which he decides to either believe or not to believe in a superior power, all this is directly related to his innermost integrity, his honesty with himself, his full desire to be truthful with himself on all matters. Therefore it is entirely correct to state that any misconception in his psyche which creates negative chain reactions is a result of his not wanting to be in truth. For one reason or another, he believes that not being in truth is better for him than when he is being in truth. This then results in one of those negative, self-perpetuating chain reactions.

Not knowing that all the possibilities, that all perfection, that all fulfillment is already a reality deep within the nucleus of the self, is directly connected with a deliberate misconception about one's personal life. Now, I come back to a point made at the beginning of this lecture, that man often wants to ignore the possibilities and powers within himself. He also does so partly because he derives pleasure from complaining and from unhappiness. Partly he truly fears these powers. He fears the possibility of happiness. He fears that he may not be able to handle it. He fears the ecstasy of a perfectly lived life as he fears death, as he fears all great experience that takes him out of himself. It is this vague, unformulated fear which makes man deliberately embrace negativity and (unconsciously) deliberately violate the laws which afford him the unfoldment we speak of here. It is only when he has involved himself to a considerable degree in such a negative chain reaction, with all its painfulness and frustration, that he will long to go back to the point of departure, point by point, to the links in his self-created chain reaction until he reaches the level of origin with all its potentials and powers. Finally, he will no longer shy away from the ecstasy of a really lived life where abundance, truth, love, and the unlimited possibilities in every direction of his being exist. But he still has to acclimate himself to new air to breathe, and such acclimation is possible only when he becomes truly willing to give up negativity and destructiveness.

In the last few lectures, we discussed the fact that many of you are now beginning, little by little, to discover your deliberate destructiveness, how you want to be destructive, how you wallow in this desire for being destructive. And this is great progress, my friends, for if you do not know this, then indeed you are further away in the removal of yourself from the level of your being where all good exists, and you need to find this essential link. Not knowing what you feel and what you want and what you aim for makes it impossible to go in any direction. It puts you in the famous trap in which you are paralyzed, numb, and lifeless. So, first, all your aims, all your desires and wishes -- constructive or not, no matter how unconscious until now -- must be acknowledged. This is an essential part of this work which we are doing together. Once this has happened, you can ascertain, as some of you have begun to do, that you are deliberately destructive in those areas in which you are unhappy. Then, when you are aware of this, you are no longer quite so far removed. But the majority of my friends, now, have found this deliberate destructiveness (and those who have not still have to come to this realization), I would urge you to look at yourselves in this light. You will find that you have not yet come to the point when you truly issue the desire to give up this destructiveness; that you do not truly want to turn from this destructiveness to a constructive, including, friendly attitude to life and to others. You still do not wish to give up self-centeredness

and isolation and accept a new way of life in which you include others, in which you build instead of destroy, in which you want to contribute even if this means that the importance of the little ego has to be relinquished. The desire to be with others instead of against them has to be expressed. This entire new attitude and way of life has to be actively wanted, embraced, cultivated. It does not happen otherwise, it does not come by itself unless the ego wishes for it.

Only then can all your fears, all your sense of worthlessness vanish. And yet, the destructiveness claims to become less worthless by being destructive. That is the error in which most of you here still find yourself now. On that level, you have to work. Now, when you can make this essential decision to give up destructiveness, you will find a battle in you. You will find a greater fear of constructive unfoldment, of happiness and fullness than of confinement and pain. This may appear preposterous, yet when you test your feelings, you will find this to be so. Issue the following thoughts unto your psyche: "My deliberate destructiveness is that and that and that (whatever you have found it to be in your personal work). I truly desire to give it up. I want constructiveness. I choose this not by any force or obligation, but because I wish this to be so." You will, at that moment, find a fear. This tiny little nucleus of fear, still vague, hazy, unpronounced -- it is this nucleus of fear that we have to bring out into focus. This is the point of the chain reaction at which the majority of you now stand -- or will shortly come to if your work proceeds according to the possibilities you have available at this time. Either you are already there, or you are about to discover and bring into focus the destructiveness.

Then the next point is why do you like to hold on to it? Why do you actually find it safer than the limitless expansion of good that opens up when you let go of destructiveness, negation, denial, negativity. What is this fear? This must be the point. I am afraid that this cannot be elaborated on tonight, for it is a lecture in itself. But we shall go into this. Perhaps some of you have something to contribute to this topic, or questions to ask, that will lead or help lead all of you into this next phase, to this next link in the chain reaction, this next point I indicated here. When we understand the fear you have of good, because of which you cling to the negative, then you are no longer far from that original core where all you need exists, where you can be in touch with this center of yourself that gives you all the powers to master your life and to unfold it to the best of possibilities. But so many hazy, foggy, unclear areas have to be cleared up before this point can be reached. When you do not want to see the destructiveness, the deliberateness of it, you are stuck. This is basically the most important point of this work. All others are side issues, details that have to be gone through in order to become acutely aware of the deliberate destructiveness and avoidance of productive, positive unfoldment.

Does anyone here have any inkling, any realization of this fear of letting go of the destructiveness? The fear of good, in which destructiveness feels more safe? Does anyone have a question in this regard?

QUESTION: I had an experience along these lines where I made the decision to give up my destructiveness and cruelty and enlisted my divine self. I was going along nicely until the test came up, and then I just ran the other way. I couldn't face it, and all the old negative, destructive emotions returned. I suffered and suffered. I couldn't stop it. I didn't know until now, when you mentioned it, that it was fear.

ANSWER: Then you are exactly now at the point I discussed, exactly. Anyone else who has something to ask or to contribute?

QUESTION: This is a subject with which I have struggled for a long time, and I am well aware of this fear. The only thing I can contribute here is to say that the only way I can work with it at the moment is through constant awareness of it and by meditation on the subject and the realization of the tremendous fear of joy and of relaxed happiness. Everything tenses up when things go well and I am happy. My whole body becomes almost incapable of relaxation; I get into too much activity. Even though it is outwardly constructive activity, it is destructive to happiness. And I would like to know if there is any other thing I can do at the moment to get out of this?

ANSWER: Yes, I would concentrate at the moment -- at the same time while you issue into yourself the desire for constructiveness, happiness, fulfillment -- and express the knowledge that this possibility exists in you. At the same time, it is necessary that you become more acutely aware of the deliberate destructiveness. For there is, of course, a direct tie between the two, as I have indicated in this lecture. To the extent that deliberate destructiveness is unconscious and therefore cannot be given up, happiness cannot be embraced. When you comprehend the deliberate destructiveness and in what form it exists (not necessarily in action, but perhaps predominantly in hidden emotions, which can only lead to indirect corresponding actions as well as to vague thoughts and half-conscious wishes), when this is concisely crystallized in your consciousness, then you will immediately understand what blocks you. Then the next step we are coming to will be available to you. As I have said, I will go more fully into this topic in the next lecture. We may also have some more preparation in our session devoted to questions and answers. We shall go into an entire lecture about this fear, but not under any circumstances can this fear be comprehended when the deliberate destructiveness is not conscious. This is what I advise you to work on, my dear.

QUESTION: I have become aware of this destructiveness quite recently. It is very clear to me that this destructiveness is directed against my mother. I sabotage the positive aspects of life because I want to spite her and, in a way, prove to her that whatever she expects of me I am not going to fulfill. Now, this is quite clear. At the same time there is a resistance to change it. When I find myself in a situation when I can do this and no longer wish to adhere to this irrational senseless pattern, something stops me. I feel that I am afraid of giving up something which I am not able to pinpoint, except that I know that I cling to it tenaciously. It is some kind of a hope which would be some kind of a magical transformation of my life. Maybe you can give me a little illumination about this fear?

ANSWER: Let me say about this fear, now, only that this is a very fundamental fear of dissolving. You might call it the fear of death, but it is much more than that. This presents itself whenever man is in flux, when the personality is truly vibrating in the harmony of the cosmic forces, which might be in what is called death. It occurs also in other instances, but it does not always occur in so-called death. This depends on the state of development. The fearful person feels this as a terrifying dissolution of self. This fear also applies to union between the sexes. It exists in any creative state in which the ego is not very strongly tied to the inner being. It is this dissolving and unifying with the universal stream of being which man fears. Such dissolving and giving up of the little self also exists, of course, in unhealthy states, through sickness, through drugs, etc. When the ego is lost because it was too weak, it is unhealthy. But when man has gained a healthy ego, he must come to the point when he can let go of it. This letting go appears frightening. It is a question of

trust. As long as man does not have a deep trust in himself, he cannot trust the universal forces. By letting go of the little ego, he will become more of an individual and will refind himself. This trust in the self grows commensurately with the giving up of destructiveness. First, the destructiveness has to be given up before man can let go of himself. Then, when he understands this fear, it will be easier to do this. This is, roughly speaking, the deep, inherent fear.

QUESTION: Would you say that overemotionalism is destructive?

ANSWER: Of course, everything that is "overexaggerated," implies an imbalance, a disturbance.

QUESTION: How can you fight it?

ANSWER: Fighting implies a forceful disciplining away by suppression, and this is not real development. Real development must produce a personality that needs not be on its guard, that can afford to be relaxed and confident in its own inner processes. This state can be attained by investigating in what particular way this overemotionalism exists. It probably manifests only in certain ways, while other emotions are impoverished in proportion with the overflow of emotions in other respects. When the personality does not dare to invest natural, spontaneous feelings in certain areas, out of fear, out of alienation, out of a deliberate and false defense mechanism, then there is an overemotionalism in other areas, as it always happens in the human personality. Nature tries to reestablish balance when the natural order is disturbed. This balance must be reestablished for the personality to be in harmony and peace. When the underemotionalism has been corrected and the individual allowed to fill this void, the overemotionalism will cease. Both manifestations are painful, the emptiness as well as the "too much." Both these pains will turn into pleasure when harmony has been attained.

QUESTION: I stick to a guilt feeling because I get a negative, destructive pleasure out of it. If I would let go of this, I would feel (perfectly irrationally) that then, being happy, I would fear death. I feel that death does not matter when I am unhappy, so I do not permit myself to be happy.

ANSWER: The moment you can recognize such a thing, you have the power to give it up. Again, this amounts to fear of death, the fear of having no individuality, no consciousness. This fear can be met only when trust exists -- primarily the trust in the self. And this trust cannot be established as long as the personality plays such magical, childish, bargaining and, in the last analysis, dishonest games.

My friends, when you want to find your way back to this inner center, to this inner motion, it finally always comes down to the point at which you say "I let go." Whether this letting go means giving up destructiveness, cruelty, evasion, or any other unproductive way of life, or whether this letting go is entrusting yourself to the flow of life, it must finally come to this ability to let go. As long as you stem against it, you produce a disharmony between your life flow and the cosmic flow, of which you are part. It is like a river which is disturbed in its quiet flow by obstructions and strong countercurrents. The disturbance created in this universal flow can be eliminated only by finding this flow and by entrusting yourself to it. It is necessary to entrust yourself to it and await what comes. It is not a giving up of personality, of individuality, or of consciousness -- not by any means.

But you can find the truth of this statement only when you try it. When your consciousness is a too tight nucleus, this harmony cannot be established. The outer ego has become too strong, and too much trust has been placed in it, in a distorted way, while insufficient trust is given to other levels of the personality which function autonomously when given a chance and with which the outer ego must eventually integrate for this harmonious functioning to occur. When overemphasis is laid on the outer ego, the result is separation from this autonomously functioning center which is constantly at one with the universal stream. This is the separation we have discussed in this lecture. When you let go and entrust yourself to this life stream, to this cosmic reality of being, when you give yourself up to it, your ego will not cease to be. It will truly be a relaxed part of that greater consciousness within you. This will mean a security in yourself such as you have never known.

This finally amounts to an act of entrusting yourself. This final act must come. Occasionally, with some, it comes, earlier on this path (to some degree only, of course). With others, it comes later, but come it must. And when I say on this path, I mean much more than merely this particular work, in this particular group. I mean a way of life, your life as such. If a life is rightly lived, it comes to this. It comes to all these awarenesses, to all these inner actions and transformations. It comes to the giving up of all negativity which we discuss here from so many different angles.

Now, my friends, I bless all of you. May this lecture, these words, help you to go the way within that needs to be trod. May it help you to realize that everything you can possibly desire is within yourself. May it help you to realize that there is nothing to fear, that letting go and entrusting yourself to the life stream, to the good and the unfoldment you cringe away from is nothing to fear.

Be blessed, every one of you. Be enveloped in the strength and the love and the truth that can transcend you, if you let it. Be in peace. Be in God!

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